

TEST 10

Part 1

Question	Answer	Location	Explain
1	285	Speaker A: It depends. Well, for one adult, the charge is 154 pounds a year, but for family membership, that's two adults and up to two children, it's 285 pounds. Speaker B: Okay, well that doesn't sound too bad.	- Đáp án là 285 - Script nói rõ giá family membership là 285 pounds annually. - Key word: + family membership (n): gói gia đình + annually (adv): hàng năm
2	parking	Speaker A: That's free for our members, and there's always plenty of space. Speaker B: Okay, well that's certainly something to think about.	- Đáp án là parking - "That's free" liên quan trực tiếp đến parking (chỗ đỗ xe). - Key word: + parking (n): chỗ đỗ xe + free (adj): miễn phí
3	September	Speaker A: Well, these membership charges are fixed until August, but in September, they could go up, so I'd recommend that if you are interested, you join straight away. Speaker B: Well, it does depend a bit on what facilities you have.	- Đáp án là September - Giá có thể tăng vào tháng 9. - Key word: + fixed (adj): cố định + go up (v): tăng
4	roof	Speaker A: The main pool's lovely. It's 25 meters, and the roof is all made of glass, so you get lots of natural light. And there's a separate pool for children.	- Đáp án là roof - "roof is all made of glass" → đặc điểm chính của hồ bơi. - Key word: + roof (n): mái + glass (n): kính
5	orientation	Speaker A: Well, if you become a member, you get a session for orientation on the cardio and weights equipment in the gym, given by one of our qualified staff. That normally costs 15 pounds per person, so it's a very good deal.	- Đáp án là orientation - "session for orientation" → buổi hướng dẫn. - Key word: + orientation (n): hướng dẫn + equipment (n): thiết bị

6	TV	Speaker A: And one thing that's very popular is there's TV installed on some of the equipment, so you can watch as you work out. Speaker B: Okay.	- Đáp án là TV - "TV installed on some of the equipment" → thiết bị có TV. - Key word: + TV (n): tivi + installed (v): lắp đặt
7	judo	Speaker A: On Tuesdays, we do judo. We have different classes suitable for all levels. The only requirement is that you're over 16, I'm afraid.	- Đáp án là judo - "On Tuesdays, we do judo" → lớp học ngày Tuesday. - Key word: + judo (n): môn võ judo + classes (n): lớp học
8	yoga	Speaker B: What about yoga? I know my wife's keen to take that up again. Speaker A: We have a class on Wednesdays.	- Đáp án là yoga - "class on Wednesdays" → yoga vào Wednesday. - Key word: + yoga (n): yoga + class (n): lớp
9	intermediate	Speaker A: Well, the Wednesday class is for intermediate students, so it might be okay for her. She can try it out for one lesson to see, and then sign up if she thinks it's going to suit her.	- Đáp án là intermediate - "class is for intermediate students" → trình độ. - Key word: + intermediate (adj): trung cấp + students (n): học viên
10	8.30	Speaker A: Well, there's one class at 6.30 p.m., but it's full up, so we're opening a new one at 8.30 the same evening. Speaker B: Right. Well, that would be better for us, actually.	- Đáp án là 8.30 - "new one at 8.30" → giờ lớp mới. - Key word: + class (n): lớp + opening (v): mở

Speaker A: Good morning, Health and Fitness Center.

Speaker B: Oh, good morning. I was thinking of joining the center, but I'd like to find out a bit more about your facilities first. For example, what are your opening hours?

Speaker A: We open every day at 7 a.m. and close at 11 p.m. during the week, and 9.30 at weekends.

Speaker B: Right. And how much does membership cost?

Speaker A: Was this for yourself?

Speaker B: Well, probably for my wife as well, and maybe the children.

Speaker A: It depends. Well, for one adult, the charge is 154 pounds a year, but for family membership, that's two adults and up to two children, it's 285 pounds.

Speaker B: Okay, well that doesn't sound too bad. Right. Now, we actually live quite near, but with the children, I expect we'd be driving there, so what's the situation about parking?

Speaker A: That's free for our members, and there's always plenty of space.

Speaker B: Okay, well that's certainly something to think about. We've been thinking of joining a fitness center for a bit, but we've never got round to it.

Speaker A: Well, these membership charges are fixed until August, but in September, they could go up, so I'd recommend that if you are interested, you join straight away.

Speaker B: Well, it does depend a bit on what facilities you have. One thing we're all very keen on is swimming, for example, right?

Speaker A: Well, there are two pools. The main pool's lovely. It's 25 meters, and the roof is all made of glass, so you get lots of natural light. And there's a separate pool for children.

Speaker B: And what about the gym?

Speaker A: Well, if you become a member, you get a session for orientation on the cardio and weights equipment in the gym, given by one of our qualified staff. That normally costs 15 pounds per person, so it's a very good deal. And one thing that's very popular is there's TV installed on some of the equipment, so you can watch as you work out.

Speaker B: Okay.

Speaker A: Now, we do also have a program of evening classes. I don't know if you'd like me to give you any information about them at this stage.

Speaker B: Sure.

Speaker A: Well, I'll just give you a few examples now, but do ask if there's anything in particular you're interested in. For example, our Monday squash class is very popular.

Speaker B: I've never played it, but I like to learn. So is it aimed at beginners?

Speaker A: Yes, that's right.

Speaker B: Okay. Well, I might well be interested.

Speaker A: On Tuesdays, we do judo. We have different classes suitable for all levels. The only requirement is that you're over 16, I'm afraid. We can't cater for anyone younger than that at present.

Speaker B: No problem. What about yoga? I know my wife's keen to take that up again.

Speaker A: We have a class on Wednesdays. I take it she's not a beginner.

Speaker B: No. In fact, she used to be at advanced level, but she's probably a bit rusty, as she hasn't done any for a few years now.

Speaker A: Well, the Wednesday class is for intermediate students, so it might be okay for her. She can try it out for one lesson to see, and then sign up if she thinks it's going to suit her.

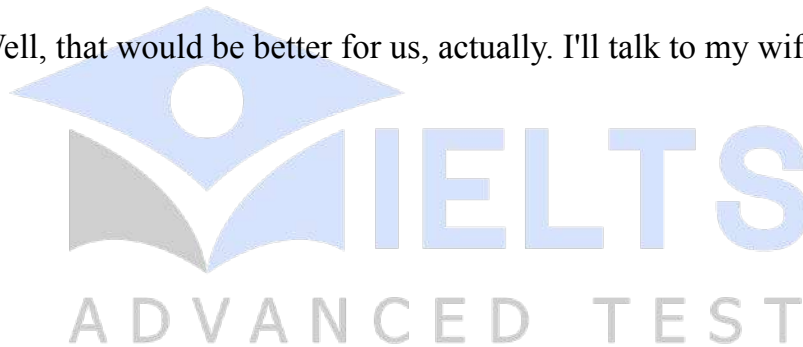
Speaker B: Thanks. I'll let her know.

Speaker A: And I don't know if either you or your wife would be interested, but we do have classes on Thursday evenings for people interested in improving their diet as a way of staying healthy.

Speaker B: Hmm. Well, I suppose we both might be, but it would depend what time.

Speaker A: Well, there's one class at 6.30 p.m., but it's full up, so we're opening a new one at 8.30 the same evening.

Speaker B: Right. Well, that would be better for us, actually. I'll talk to my wife, so if we want to join.



Part 2

Question	Answer	Location	Explain
11	B	<i>The first part of the theory course consists of a series of lessons, and you can do these either at the center in one of our classrooms or via the Internet. You work through the material at your own pace, but there's a tutor on hand to help whenever you need it.</i>	- Đáp án là B - “lessons... in classrooms” → classroom-based. - Key word: + classroom (n): lớp học + lessons (n): bài học
12	E	<i>At the second stage, we review what we've covered so far. We do this in the classroom.</i>	- Đáp án là E - “review what we've covered” → revision. - Key word: + review (v): ôn tập + covered (v): đã học
13	C	<i>Provided you pass that test, you then get your provisional driving license, which you need before you can venture onto public highways.</i>	- Đáp án là C - “get your provisional driving license” → bằng tạm. - Key word: + provisional (adj): tạm thời + license (n): bằng lái
14	B	<i>The practical course starts off here at the test center, and it consists of training and assessment on our specially designed circuit. This allows you to get driving experience immediately, but in a safe environment.</i>	- Đáp án là B - “on our specially designed circuit” → circuit-based. - Key word: + circuit (n): đường vòng + assessment (n): đánh giá
15	H	<i>Then, when both you and your instructor think you're ready, you do a trial test, and if that goes well, you go straight on to do the official test run by the RTD. Finally, provided that you're successful in both parts of the course, the theory and the practice, you get your driving license.</i>	- Đáp án là H - “official test run by the RTD” → RTD test. - Key word: + official test (n): bài thi chính thức + RTD (n): cơ quan giao thông

16	A	<i>Finally, provided that you're successful in both parts of the course, the theory and the practice, you get your driving license. You're then on probation for a year, and as long as you don't have any problems in that time, your license will be endorsed for future use.</i>	- Đáp án là A - “on probation for a year” → 12 months probation. - Key word: + probation (n): thử thách + year (n): năm
17	B	<i>For the theory course, there's no need to book, and if you're going to do classroom-based lessons, you can just turn up here at the center and pay as you go. We run six sessions a day, and if you go to our website, you'll find the start times for each session.</i>	- Đáp án là B - “go to our website” → thông tin trên internet. - A sai vì “no need to book”. - C sai vì không cần trả trước toàn bộ. - Key word: + website (n): trang web + sessions (n): buổi học
18	A	<i>As for the classes themselves, all our theory classes are run by experienced tutors, and they're offered in a number of different languages as well as in English. We deliver the content using PowerPoint, but there's still a place for pen and paper tasks, and we ask you to bring your own stationary to the lessons.</i>	- Đáp án là A - “offered in a number of different languages” → nhiều ngôn ngữ. - B sai vì phải mang stationary. - C sai vì học linh hoạt. - Key word: + languages (n): ngôn ngữ + offered (v): cung cấp
19	C	<i>That's a bit more complicated, and you do have to book in advance, but you can do that via our website or at the customer service desk here at the center, or you can book at one of our self-service kiosks. You'll find them in some of the big stores in the city, so it's very convenient, whatever your situation is.</i>	- Đáp án là C - “book at... kiosks in stores” → đặt tại cửa hàng. - A sai vì không bắt buộc mỗi ngày. - B sai vì không cho dùng xe riêng. - Key word: + book (v): đặt + kiosks (n): máy tự phục vụ
20	B	<i>You can cancel lessons in the same way that you book them, but in order to avoid incurring a penalty, you have to do that at least 72 hours in advance of your appointment. When you make a cancellation in less than the required period, you can try and transfer your session to someone else.</i>	- Đáp án là B - “72 hours in advance” → thông báo trước thì không mất phí. - A sai vì không nhắc instructor. - C sai vì không chấp nhận medical certificate. - Key word: + in advance (adv): trước + penalty (n): phí phạt

Safety Driving Center, hello.

Hello. Can you give me some information about driving lessons?

Yes. There are two courses, one on theory and one practical course, and most people do the two courses simultaneously.

The first part of the theory course consists of a series of lessons, and you can do these either at the center in one of our classrooms or via the Internet. You work through the material at your own pace, but there's a tutor on hand to help whenever you need it.

At the second stage, we review what we've covered so far. We do this in the classroom. We don't deliver it online, so you have to come into the center. At the end of this lesson, there's a test, but this is just for practice. It's not a proper RTD test. If you're satisfied with your performance on this, you can go on to the next stage, and if you're not, you can go back to stage one and follow the lessons again.

The third stage is the real test, the one set and administered by the RTD. That's the Road Traffic Department. Provided you pass that test, you then get your provisional driving license, which you need before you can venture onto public highways.

The practical course starts off here at the test center, and it consists of training and assessment on our specially designed circuit. This allows you to get driving experience immediately, but in a safe environment. At the next stage, you continue with training and assessment, but on public highways. Obviously, you can't do this until you've obtained your provisional license to show that you've got some knowledge of traffic regulations and road safety.

Then, when both you and your instructor think you're ready, you do a trial test, and if that goes well, you go straight on to do the official test run by the RTD. Finally, provided that you're successful in both parts of the course, the theory and the practice, you get your driving license. You're then on probation for a year, and as long as you don't have any problems in that time, your license will be endorsed for future use.

Can you tell me how to enroll?

Yes, it's quite easy. For the theory course, there's no need to book, and if you're going to do classroom-based lessons, you can just turn up here at the center and pay as you go. We run six sessions a day, and if you go to our website, you'll find the start times for each session. If you don't have internet access, you can pick up a leaflet from the center here with that information.

As for the classes themselves, all our theory classes are run by experienced tutors, and they're offered in a number of different languages as well as in English. We deliver the content using PowerPoint, but there's still a place for pen and paper tasks, and we ask you to bring your own stationary to the lessons.

You choose the particular stage of the course that you want each time. Some people attend more frequently than others, and so they progress through the course at a faster rate.

What about enrolling on the practical course?

That's a bit more complicated, and you do have to book in advance, but you can do that via our website or at the customer service desk here at the center, or you can book at one of our self-service kiosks. You'll find them in some of the big stores in the city, so it's very convenient, whatever your situation is.

You can attend between one and seven sessions a week, so you can decide whether you want to do the course intensively or spread it out more. Some driving schools allow you to drive your own car, but for safety and insurance reasons, we don't.

You can cancel lessons in the same way that you book them, but in order to avoid incurring a penalty, you have to do that at least 72 hours in advance of your appointment. When you make a cancellation in less than the required period, you can try and transfer your session to someone else. If another trainee then agrees to take the session over, your payment for the canceled session can be credited back to your account. Otherwise, we can't give a refund for any reason, and even a medical certificate isn't accepted as grounds for granting one.

Part 3

Question	Answer	Location	Explain
21	C	Gareth: OK. And as you might expect from people wanting to study music, they all had a degree of proficiency in at least two instruments. Lorna: But in most cases, one of the instruments was dominant.	- Đáp án là C - “at least two instruments” → chơi hơn 1 nhạc cụ. - A sai vì “wasn't the case when they arrived”. - B không được nhấn mạnh. - Key word: + proficiency (n): thành thạo + instruments (n): nhạc cụ
22	D	Lorna: I thought the most interesting finding was that before coming here, almost everyone was involved in a chamber orchestra or band or singing in a choir and playing in front of live audiences. Gareth: But varying enormously in size.	- Đáp án là D - “playing in front of live audiences” → biểu diễn trước công chúng. - E sai vì chỉ “access to a piano” không phải điểm chính. - Key word: + live audiences (n): khán giả trực tiếp + performing (v): biểu diễn
23	C	Lorna: The most striking thing here is that even students who you'd expect to practice for hours every day until they get it perfect, say it's being terrified of failing that really makes them practice. Gareth: I know I'm the same.	- Đáp án là C - “terrified of failing” → luyện tập vì sợ thất bại. - Key word: + terrified (adj): sợ hãi + failing (n): thất bại
24	E	Gareth: What most of them agree on is that there's nothing more rewarding than mastering something that's really hard to learn. Lorna: That's right.	- Đáp án là E - “rewarding... hard to learn” → thích thử thách khó. - Key word: + rewarding (adj): đáng giá + mastering (v): làm chủ
25	C	Lorna: I think the first thing to say is that a high percentage said they would always try to learn their pieces by heart because it's too easy to get lost if you're trying to read and play when you're nervous. Gareth: OK.	- Đáp án là C - “learn their pieces by heart” → chơi từ trí nhớ. - Key word: + by heart (phr): thuộc lòng + nervous (adj): lo lắng

26	A	Gareth: OK. And quite a lot of them said it helps to listen to other people playing your chosen piece, preferably recordings, but even just other students. Lorna: So finally, we need to look at the findings for students' attitudes to performing.	- Đáp án là A - “helps to listen to other people playing” → thích nghe người khác chơi. - Key word: + listen (v): nghe + recordings (n): bản thu
27	B	Gareth: I expected to find that performing solo would make students very nervous, but in fact, that isn't the case. Lorna: They do find it hugely challenging to start with, but they appreciate the challenge and find it stimulating.	- Đáp án là B - “challenging... stimulating” → khó nhưng thú vị. - Key word: + challenging (adj): thử thách + stimulating (adj): thú vị
28	E	Gareth: But the most commonly cited answer was that it took them ages to make their minds up. Lorna: I suppose it's because there are so many factors involved.	- Đáp án là E - “took them ages” → tốn thời gian. - Key word: + ages (n): rất lâu + factors (n): yếu tố
29	G	Lorna: Then there's performing with musicians from a different genre, like a classical musician playing with a jazz group. Gareth: That can really be fun. Lorna: But most of the music students had never even considered it.	- Đáp án là G - “never even considered it” → hiếm khi xảy ra. - Key word: + considered (v): cân nhắc + genre (n): thể loại
30	A	Lorna: Yes, they all said it was incredibly helpful and not at all intimidating, which says a lot for the department's ethos. Gareth: Yes, that's a good point.	- Đáp án là A - “incredibly helpful” → rất có lợi. - Key word: + helpful (adj): hữu ích + intimidating (adj): đáng sợ

Lorna: So Gareth, we need to organize the findings from our survey on music students for the final presentation.

Gareth: Yes, Lorna. I think we've got some very interesting results.

Lorna: Obviously we need to start by saying that we interviewed all the third year students doing a music degree and state the objective of our research project, that is to find out about their attitudes to performing.

Gareth: And then we should talk about the students' musical backgrounds before coming to university.

Lorna: The most important points to make are that although most people have actually composed music during the course, that wasn't the case when they arrived. And the other thing they had in common was the piano.

Gareth: Well, they'd had access to a piano at some point, but not all had studied it formally.

Lorna: I thought the most interesting finding was that before coming here, almost everyone was involved in a chamber orchestra or band or singing in a choir and playing in front of live audiences.

Gareth: But varying enormously in size.

Lorna: Some had only played in tiny venues. I think it's worth saying that.

Gareth: OK. And as you might expect from people wanting to study music, they all had a degree of proficiency in at least two instruments.

Lorna: But in most cases, one of the instruments was dominant.

Gareth: Right. We need to talk about attitudes to music practice.

Lorna: The most striking thing here is that even students who you'd expect to practice for hours every day until they get it perfect, say it's being terrified of failing that really makes them practice.

Gareth: I know I'm the same.

Lorna: Me too. It's interesting what was said about practicing alone.

Gareth: Some people preferred that because they could focus more on their weak points.

Lorna: But that wasn't a majority view.

Gareth: What most of them agree on is that there's nothing more rewarding than mastering something that's really hard to learn.

Lorna: That's right. OK, after that, we should talk a bit about the pieces that students select for assessed performances.

Gareth: There wasn't quite so much consensus on this, was there?

Lorna: A few people prefer to do pieces which are relatively unknown, while others choose the ones they think will show off their technical ability.

Gareth: But they were in the minority.

Lorna: I think the first thing to say is that a high percentage said they would always try to learn their pieces by heart because it's too easy to get lost if you're trying to read and play when you're nervous.

Gareth: OK. And quite a lot of them said it helps to listen to other people playing your chosen piece, preferably recordings, but even just other students.

Lorna: So finally, we need to look at the findings for students' attitudes to performing.

Gareth: We should point out that this includes informal and formal public performances as well as assessed ones.

Lorna: Yes, that's important.

Gareth: I expected to find that performing solo would make students very nervous, but in fact, that isn't the case.

Lorna: They do find it hugely challenging to start with, but they appreciate the challenge and find it stimulating.

Gareth: Right. I was surprised by what students said about deciding which pieces to perform.

Lorna: I thought they'd all say this was easy. For me, it's always been quite straightforward.

Gareth: Which pieces do I like best and which pieces can I play well?

Lorna: And my repertoire is quite limited anyway.

Gareth: But the most commonly cited answer was that it took them ages to make their minds up.

Lorna: I suppose it's because there are so many factors involved.

Gareth: You need to consider your audience, the venue, the time available to learn the piece, especially if it's complicated.

Lorna: You need to think about all these things, and you can't do that in a hurry.

Gareth: That's true.

Lorna: Then there's performing with musicians from a different genre, like a classical musician playing with a jazz group.

Gareth: That can really be fun.

Lorna: But most of the music students had never even considered it.

Gareth: Right. For performing with musicians who play the same instrument, almost everyone put the same thing.

Lorna: Yes, they all said it was incredibly helpful and not at all intimidating, which says a lot for the department's ethos.

Gareth: Yes, that's a good point. OK, what I think we should sort out now...

Part 4

Question	Answer	Location	Explain
31	cliffs	<i>In fact, the earliest coal was moved by hand from the base of the cliffs along the island's coast. It was a harsh and dangerous task, as workers had to navigate slippery rocks while carrying heavy loads of coal in baskets.</i>	- Đáp án là cliffs - “from the base of the cliffs” → nơi lấy than đầu tiên. - Key word: + cliffs (n): vách đá + base (n): chân
32	transport	<i>For production to grow, Cape Breton needed a well-organised transport network. Initially, they used horse-drawn carts, but as output rose, they introduced railway lines that could carry larger quantities to the port for shipping.</i>	- Đáp án là transport - “transport network” → hệ thống vận chuyển. - Key word: + transport (n): vận chuyển + network (n): hệ thống
33	spring	<i>Every year, particularly in spring, new groups of labourers would arrive to take advantage of seasonal jobs. Spring was an ideal time, not just because of the weather, but because mining operations expanded significantly during the warmer months.</i>	- Đáp án là spring - “particularly in spring” → thời điểm người lao động đến. - Key word: + spring (n): mùa xuân + labourers (n): lao động
34	rural	<i>Villages near the mines grew, while the population in more rural regions started to decline. Families often moved together, and mining towns quickly expanded, sometimes without adequate planning or infrastructure.</i>	- Đáp án là rural - “rural regions started to decline” → vùng nông thôn giảm dân. - Key word: + rural (adj): nông thôn + decline (v): giảm

35	40%	<i>At its peak, the island was supplying around 40% of all coal used in Canada. This boom not only supported the domestic energy supply, but also provided fuel for export to other countries.</i>	- Đáp án là 40% - “supplying around 40%” → tỷ lệ cung cấp. - Key word: + peak (n): đỉnh + supply (v): cung cấp
36	Scotland	<i>Most of the early migrants came from Scotland, particularly from mining towns in the central and western regions. These skilled Scottish miners brought valuable knowledge and traditions with them, shaping the way mining was carried out in Canada.</i>	- Đáp án là Scotland - “came from Scotland” → nguồn lao động chính. - Key word: + migrants (n): người di cư + Scotland (n): Scotland
37	candle	<i>A slightly improved version was to mount a candle in a metal or clay holder. These holders were usually attached to the timber supports inside the tunnels.</i>	- Đáp án là candle - “mount a candle in a... holder” → candle holder. - Key word: + candle (n): nến + holder (n): giá đỡ
38	lock	<i>This device had a flame enclosed in mesh and featured a fitted link sealed by a lock. The design controlled the airflow and prevented the flame from igniting any methane gas in the air.</i>	- Đáp án là lock - “sealed by a lock” → bộ phận khóa. - Key word: + lock (n): khóa + sealed (v): bịt kín
39	accidents	<i>Because of this innovation, the number of accidents, such as explosions or fires, dropped significantly across many mining sites. Later, carbide lamps were introduced.</i>	- Đáp án là accidents - “number of accidents... dropped” → giảm tai nạn. - Key word: + accidents (n): tai nạn + explosions (n): vụ nổ
40	water	<i>These worked by combining calcium carbide with water, which created acetylene gas. When lit, it gave off a steady yellow-white flame that was much brighter than previous sources.</i>	- Đáp án là water - “combining... with water” → chất trộn. - Key word: + combine (v): kết hợp + water (n): nước

Today I'm going to talk about the history and technological development of coal mining on Cape Breton Island, located off the east coast of Canada in Nova Scotia. This area played a critical role in Canada's energy production for over two centuries.

Let's begin with the early days.

Coal mining in Cape Breton dates back to the 1720s, during the French colonial period. These first operations were extremely basic. The miners didn't use machines. They relied on manual labour to gather the coal. In fact, the earliest coal was moved by hand from the base of the cliffs along the island's coast. It was a harsh and dangerous task, as workers had to navigate slippery rocks while carrying heavy loads of coal in baskets.

Now, as demand for coal increased, it became clear that new systems had to be developed to handle the growing volume. The ability to transport coal efficiently became one of the biggest challenges facing the industry. For production to grow, Cape Breton needed a well-organised transport network. Initially, they used horse-drawn carts, but as output rose, they introduced railway lines that could carry larger quantities to the port for shipping.

This increase in industrial activity also brought about changes in the workforce. Every year, particularly in spring, new groups of labourers would arrive to take advantage of seasonal jobs. Spring was an ideal time, not just because of the weather, but because mining operations expanded significantly during the warmer months. By summer, mines would be fully staffed with both local residents and new arrivals from other parts of Canada and abroad. Naturally, this shift in employment patterns had consequences for local demographics. Many people who had lived in remote or agricultural areas began to relocate. Villages near the mines grew, while the population in more rural regions started to decline. Families often moved together, and mining towns quickly expanded, sometimes without adequate planning or infrastructure.

By the early 20th century, Cape Breton had become a major player in the national coal industry. At its peak, the island was supplying around 40% of all coal used in Canada. This boom not only supported the domestic energy supply, but also provided fuel for export to other countries.

Let's talk about the workers themselves.

Around the year 1800, the local workforce could no longer meet the demand. To fill the gap, labourers were recruited from abroad. Most of the early migrants came from Scotland, particularly from mining towns in the central and western regions. These skilled Scottish miners brought valuable knowledge and traditions with them, shaping the way mining was carried out in Canada. Italian workers also played a key role, especially in the construction of railways and tunnels.

Now, let's look at the technology used in underground mining, specifically how the tunnels were lit before electricity became widespread.

The earliest source of light was a grease torch. This simple tool burned animal fat to produce a flickering flame. It was cheap and easy to make, but produced a lot of smoke and posed a serious fire risk.

A slightly improved version was to mount a candle in a metal or clay holder. These holders were usually attached to the timber supports inside the tunnels. While candles were more manageable than grease torches, they still had open flames and were far from safe in gas-prone environments. The invention of the Davy lamp marked a huge step forward in mine safety. This device had a flame enclosed in mesh and featured a fitted link sealed by a lock. The design controlled the airflow and prevented the flame from igniting any methane gas in the air. Because of this innovation, the number of accidents, such as explosions or fires, dropped significantly across many mining sites. Later, carbide lamps were introduced. These worked by combining calcium carbide with water, which created acetylene gas. When lit, it gave off a steady yellow-white flame that was much brighter than previous sources. These lamps were widely used until electric lighting eventually replaced them in the 20th century.

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